

# Clíodhna Hughes

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## Education

- 2026–2030 **University of Edinburgh**, PhD with Integrated Training in Designing Responsible Natural Language Processing.
- 2022–2025 **University of Sheffield**, MPhil with Integrated PGCert in Speech and Language Technologies and their Applications.
- Thesis: An initial investigation into the effects of facial feminisation surgery on the voice. Supervised by Prof. Guy Brown, Dr Ning Ma & Prof. Nicola Dikken. Part published in Proceedings of Interspeech 2024.
- 2018–2022 **University of Edinburgh**, MA (Hons) in Linguistics, First Class Honours Degree.
- Dissertation: Evidence for word order harmony between abstract categories in silent gesture. Supervised by Prof. Simon Kirby & Prof. Jennifer Culbertson. Awarded Angus McIntosh Prize (£100) & LAGB Prize for Outstanding Undergraduate Dissertation in Linguistics (£100). Published in Cognition.

## Employment

- Mar–May 2026 **Research Assistant in Language Evolution**, *University of Edinburgh*, UK.
- Project title: Do children follow the Principle of Least Effort? PI: Dr Shira Tal.
  - Conducting outreach activities in the National Museum of Scotland; recruiting and running participants.
- Dec 2025–May 2026 **Data Engineer – Speech Data Curation and Model Evaluation**, *Inlea at Cisco*.
- Maintaining data pipelines supporting speech technology model development. Curating, cleaning, labelling, and transforming large-scale audio datasets; designing evaluation datasets and protocols.
- Sep–Dec 2025 **Research Assistant in First Language Acquisition**, *University of Edinburgh*, UK.
- Project investigating infants' statistical learning abilities with Zipfian distributions in the visual domain. PI: Professor Inbal Arnon.
  - Designed and built the experiment in jsPsych; recruited and ran participants; analysed results.
- Feb–Aug 2025 **Research Assistant in Phonetics**, *University of Edinburgh*, UK.
- Project title: PlanArt: Planning the articulation of spoken utterances. PI: Professor Alice Turk.
  - Analysed articulatory phonetic data to test theories of speech production.
- Jun–Dec 2024 **Research Annotator**, *University of Edinburgh*, UK.
- Project title: Prosodic Structure at the Interface Between Language and Speech. PI: Professor Alice Turk.
  - Manual segmentation of a speech dataset for prosody research.

- Sep 2021– **Senior Annotator**, *University of Edinburgh, UK*.
- Feb 2024
- Project title: Charting lexical development through dense coding and analysis of word senses. PI: Professor Hugh Rabagliati.
  - Used a web-based app to code the meanings of words in a corpus of child language data, for use in research on polysemy in child language acquisition; coordinated with wider annotation team to develop protocols for consistent, high-quality labelling.
- Jun–Aug 2021 **Transcriber**, *University of Edinburgh, UK*.
- Project exploring language development of English-Gaelic bilinguals. PI: Professor Vicky Chondrogianni.
  - Transcribed child responses to a number of tasks, both in English orthography and IPA.

## Selected Academic Service

- 2025–2026 **Co-Organiser**, *Lavender Languages and Linguistics Conference (LavLang) 2026*.
- 2024–2026 **Co-Organiser**, *Special Sessions on Speech, Gender & Sexuality at Interspeech*.
- 2020–2022 **National Chair**, *Undergraduate Linguistics Association of Britain (ULAB)*.
- 2020–2022 **Founder & Associate Editor**, *Journal of the Undergraduate Linguistics Association of Britain (JoULAB)*.

## Teaching and Supervision Experience

- 2023–2024 **Co-supervisor**, *MComp Dissertation Group Project*, University of Sheffield.
- Project title: Cough Sound Analysis for Tuberculosis Screening.
- 2019–2021 **Coordinator & Volunteer**, *FamiLing Peer Support*, University of Edinburgh.
- 2018–2020 **Volunteer UK Linguistics Olympiad Tutor & Marker**, University of Edinburgh.

## Publications

- 2025 Alice Ross, **Clíodhna Hughes**, Eddie Ungless, & Catherine Lai, *Conveying gender through speech: insights from trans men*, In Proceedings of Interspeech 2025.
- 2025 **Clíodhna Hughes**, Jennifer Culbertson & Simon Kirby, *Evidence for word order harmony between abstract categories in silent gesture*, *Cognition* 259:106100.
- 2024 **Clíodhna Hughes**, Guy Brown, Ning Ma & Nicola Dikken, *Acoustic effects of facial feminisation surgery on speech and singing: A case study*, In Proceedings of Interspeech 2024.

## Selected Conference Talks and Posters

- 2026 **Lavender Language and Linguistics Conference 2026**, *LGBTQ+ Voices in Speech Data Collection and Technology Development*.
- 2025 **Interspeech Conference 2025**, *Conveying gender through speech: insights from trans men*, with Alice Ross, Eddie Ungless & Dr Catherine Lai.
- 2024 **Lavender Language and Linguistics Conference 2024**, *The Effects of Facial Feminisation Surgery on Speech and Singing: A Preliminary Study*, supervised by Prof. Guy Brown, Dr Ning Ma and Prof. Nicola Dikken.